

容详述 Only if the jobless arrive... register... and start... and then they should... ,方可准确把握新政目的:鼓励失业者积极寻找工作(以降低对救济金的依赖,使生活更好)。**二、借助“引号使用”和“反问句式”,抓取作者讽刺。**①句“change lives for the better”、reduce “dependency”引用的同时暗示作者质疑:这是奥斯本宣称的目的,但是否真的合理?③句反问(还有什么能更合理)传达作者讽刺:似乎最为合理,实际却不合理。二者共同表明首段论述角度:假借奥斯本口吻介绍新政,并暗中传达作者讽刺。

· 真题精解 ·

21. George Osborne's scheme was intended to _____.	21. 乔治·奥斯本计划旨在_____。
[A] encourage jobseekers' active engagement in job seeking	[A] 鼓励求职者积极寻找工作
[B] provide the unemployed with easier access to benefits	[B] 给失业者提供更易获得的救济
[C] guarantee jobseekers' legitimate right to benefits	[C] 保证求职者领取救济金的合法权益
[D] motivate the unemployed to report voluntarily	[D] 激励失业者主动报告

【精准定位】首段①句指出计划目的:使生活更好,并降低依赖。②句说明计划内容:失业者须带简历到求职中心、注册网上求职、并开始寻找工作,才有资格领取失业金;且之后须每周报到一次。结合两句可知,计划旨在鼓励失业者积极寻找工作、而不是依赖失业金,[A]正确。

【命题解密】正确项[A]结合②句计划内容,明确①句 In order to “change lives for the better” and reduce “dependency”所述目的。

[B]对①句 change lives for the better 断章取义,由②句可知:获得救济是“更难”、而非“更易”。[C]对②句 Only if... will they be eligible for benefit... 反向干扰:该计划是在“限制”、而不是“保障”失业者领取救济金的权利。[D]用②句 they should report 干扰,但这属于计划细节、不能体现整体目的,且文中是“强行规定(they should)”、而非“鼓励自愿(motivate... voluntarily)”。

【技巧总结】本题考查“新政目的”,且直接定位信息为抽象概述,解题时需结合新政的具体规定、针对情形等加以理解把握,切忌断章取义。

具体来看,答题时根据题干 was intended to 可直接锁定①句 In order to,并确定“change lives for the better” and reduce “dependency”为正确项来源。但由于该表述抽象概括,所以应结合②句“规定详述”加以理解,确定[A]正确。排除对直接定位信息断章取义的[B],错误理解特殊句式(倒装条件句)的[C],以及将“细节内容”当“整体目的”、且扭曲文意的[D]。

II ① More apparent reasonableness followed. ②²⁴ There will now be a seven-day wait for the jobseeker's allowance^①. ③ “Those first few days should be spent looking for work, not looking to sign on,” he claimed^②. ④ “We're doing these things because we know they help people stay off benefits^③ and help those on benefits get into work faster.” ⑤ Help? ⑥ Really? ⑦ On first hearing, this was the socially concerned chancellor, trying to change lives for the better, complete with^④ “reforms” to an obviously indulgent^⑤ system that demands too little effort from the newly unemployed to find work, and subsidises^⑥ laziness. ⑧²⁴ What motivated him, we were to understand, was his zeal^⑦ for “fundamental fairness”— protecting the taxpayer, controlling spending and ensuring that only the most deserving claimants^⑧ received their benefits.

接下来还有更明显的合理性。现在,申请求职者津贴需要经过一个七天的等待期。“最初几天应该用于寻找工作,而不是指望登记(领取救济金),”他声称。“我们之所这样做,是因为知道这能帮助人们远离救济,且能帮助那些依靠救济的人更快找到工作。帮助?真的?乍一听,这是这位心系社会的财相在通过“改革”明显具有纵容性的制度——对新失业者找工作的努力几乎不作要求,从而助长懒惰——来努力使人们生活更好。不过我们要明白,真正激励他的是对“基本公平”的热情——保护纳税人,控制开支并确保只有最需要帮助的申请者可才领到救济金。